CARLOS BARAJAS

PLATFORM ENGINEERING MANAGER

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Platform engineering manager with nearly two decades in production systems, leading teams that build internal developer platforms, CI/CD, and cloud infrastructure across Azure and AWS. Currently leads a 13-engineer platform team, principal through professional level, at Blue Shield of California (Stellarus), delivering a projected $4M modernization that replaces Digital.ai Release with Backstage-driven self-service provisioning for 40+ teams. Has managed teams of up to 24 engineers across the US, EU, India, and China while staying hands-on in technical direction, with results including production promotion cut from 7 days to 15 minutes, uptime raised from 97% to 99% across 5 platforms, and ~20 legacy applications modernized to .NET Core.

EXPERIENCE

Blue Shield of California (Stellarus)

Sr. Manager, Technical Engineering (Platform Engineering)

Feb 2026 – Present

- Lead a 13-engineer Platform Engineering team (3 principal, 5 lead, 3 senior, 2 professional) supporting an internal development platform centered on cloud infrastructure automation, where software teams own their own infrastructure, built on Azure APIs with Ansible and Digital.ai.
- Spearhead the replacement of Digital.ai Release with a Backstage-driven self-service cloud provisioning platform, managing and providing technical direction to 8 remote engineers while balancing operational work; on track for completion by June 2027 with a projected $4M in value to the company:
  - Building Backstage software templates as the interface for Azure changes, replacing free-form inputs with catalog references to simplify provisioning for 40+ teams
  - Converting ~70 Ansible playbooks into ~30 modular OpenTofu modules covering resource groups, AKS, Azure SQL, Key Vault, VMs, App Service Plans, networking, and service principals, reducing configuration drift
  - Orchestrating changes through GitHub Actions, Atlantis, and Ansible Automation Platform
  - Partnering with FinOps to turn cost approval for net-new infrastructure from a blocking gate into informed oversight
- Own CI/CD pipelines across a wide range of tech stacks: C#, Node.js, Java/Spring Boot (Maven & Gradle), Python, mobile (Kotlin & Swift), and React Native.
- Set the product roadmap transforming the platform from team self-managed infrastructure to a centralized, GitOps-driven model:
  - Foundational infrastructure with OpenTofu & Terraform
  - Application infrastructure with Crossplane
  - Backstage as the internal developer portal
  - ArgoCD for delivery and Kargo for promotion
  - DORA metrics for measuring developer productivity
- Drive migration of teams from Bitbucket & Jenkins to GitHub and GitHub Actions, incorporating agentic solutions (GitHub Copilot, Codex, Claude Code).
- Establish observability patterns with Dynatrace for proactive, agentic infrastructure.

Allergan Aesthetics (AbbVie)

Cloud Engineering Manager (Developer Experience & DevOps)

SKILLS

Leadership
Team development · global/cross-functional team management · product roadmaps · mentorship · stakeholder partnership (FinOps, Product, Security)

Cloud
Azure · AWS

Internal Developer Platform
Backstage · software catalog · software templates

Infrastructure as Code & Config Management
Terraform · OpenTofu · Crossplane · Ansible · Ansible Automation Platform · SaltStack · Puppet · Kustomize

Containers
Docker · Docker Compose · Kubernetes (EKS, AKS) · Helm · Keda

CI/CD & GitOps
GitHub Actions · GitLab · Jenkins · Bitbucket Pipelines · TeamCity · Octopus Deploy · Digital.ai · ArgoCD · Kargo · Atlantis

Languages
Go · C# · Java · Python · Node.js/NestJS · Delphi · SQL

Messaging & Data
RabbitMQ · MySQL · Postgres · MSSQL · Elasticsearch/OpenSearch

Observability & Incident Response
Datadog · Dynatrace · Grafana · Prometheus · PagerDuty · DORA metrics

Security & Compliance
ISO 27001 · CI vulnerability scanning · CI/CD and infrastructure access guardrails

AI / Agentic Dev Tooling
GitHub Copilot · Codex · Claude Code

Collaboration
Jira · Confluence · Git

EDUCATION

Coleman University
B.S. Computer Information Systems, San Diego, CA

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Santa Barbara Tax Products Group
Lead Applications Developer / Programmer Analyst
Jun 2008 – Oct 2015
Built and enhanced C#/.NET and Delphi financial-products systems, ACH and

Jun 2024 – Feb 2026

- Led 14 engineers across two teams: DevOps (10 engineers: 1 staff, 9 senior) and Developer Experience (4 platform engineers: 1 principal, 1 staff, 1 lead, 1 senior), owning engineering infrastructure and developer productivity at scale.
- Drove implementation and deployment of an internal developer portal using Spotify's Backstage, cutting the time to promote a service to production from 7 days to 15 minutes and improving service discovery, documentation, and onboarding workflows.
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to reduce friction in the development lifecycle through self-service tooling, automation, and improved onboarding.
- Set infrastructure direction for engineering teams designing, deploying, and managing workloads on AWS and Kubernetes, with an emphasis on scalability and reliability.
- Standardized service deployment patterns using Kustomize and Terraform, improving consistency across environments and reducing time to production.
- Enabled a shift-left infrastructure model with internal tools that let teams provision and manage resources independently.
- Improved CI/CD pipelines across teams using GitHub Actions, enhancing build/test/deploy efficiency and reliability.
- Directed migration of ~70 legacy workloads to containerized services using Docker and Kubernetes.
- Established observability standards and operational tooling, moving teams toward software-driven operations.

Shell Recharge Solutions

Jun 2021 – Jun 2024 · EV charging OCPP/OCPI platform · ~15K charging stations across US & EU regions

Site Reliability Engineering Manager

Oct 2021 – Jun 2024

- Led two SRE teams in the US and India totaling 10 engineers (2 leads, 8 senior), coordinating across US, EU, and India time zones; improved uptime from 97% to 99% across 5 platforms.
- Served as interim Cybersecurity Engineering Manager, ensuring the company maintained its ISO 27001 certification: enforced compliance controls, implemented guardrails between CI/CD and infrastructure access controls, added security/vulnerability checks to the CI pipeline, and drove patching across EC2 instances, base Docker images, and Java/Go applications.
- Built and ran tier 3 incident management; codified PagerDuty services integrated with Datadog and Jira in Terraform.
- Established end-to-end observability with Datadog using a code-first approach — Terraform-managed monitors, SLOs, and synthetic testing — and set logging standards for application development; the resulting metrics enabled proactive fixes and load scaling that cut incident frequency from roughly every 48 hours to once every two weeks.
- Built AWS infrastructure with Terraform, including custom modules deployed across multiple AWS accounts.
- Implemented multi-AZ architecture, primary/read-replica RDS toggling, and multi-region traffic balancing for edge locations.

Senior DevOps Engineer

Jun 2021 – Oct 2021

Green Dot Corp

Dec 2017 – Jun 2021

Site Reliability Engineering Manager

Feb 2021 – Jun 2021

- Led a 3-engineer SRE team (1 lead, 2 senior); introduced service-level objectives and error budgets, building a reliability-oriented mindset with the product team.
- Migrated .NET Core applications from VM-hosted services to Docker & Kubernetes; created Docker Compose setups for local testing and automated integration testing.
- Established a tier 3 support model, reducing product-development engagement and increasing backlog productivity.
- Automated datacenter network failover using synthetic tests.

Software Engineering Manager

Apr 2019 – Feb 2021

XML file-processing services, and co-designed the company MSSQL database.

Coleman University

Part-time Instructor, Java & JavaScript

Aug 2011 – Oct 2012

Taught object-oriented programming in Java and introductory JavaScript/web development.

INTERESTS

Martial arts (BJJ, Tai Chi, Kung Fu)

Hobby development exploring new languages and technologies

Video gaming (puzzle, strategy, base building)

- Managed 24 engineers across multiple scrum teams in the US, India, and China (1 senior principal, 3 leads, and 20 senior and professional engineers), delivering business objectives on aggressive timelines.
- Defined development and unit-testing best practices; introduced TDD with NUnit, NSubstitute, and Moq.
- Migrated ~20 legacy Delphi and .NET Framework applications to .NET Core, deployed as Docker containers.
- Established CI/CD with GitLab for Kubernetes-hosted applications.

Senior Software Engineer
Dec 2017 – Apr 2019

- Led a scrum team, coordinating with Product and Program managers to deliver business objectives.
- Introduced CI/CD with TeamCity and Octopus Deploy for Windows-hosted applications, plus a local artifact repository (ProGet) with package scanning.

Lightstream

Software Engineer
Oct 2015 – Dec 2017

- Founding member of the company's first DevOps team; owned upgrades and administration of TeamCity and Octopus Deploy.